



Newsletter Recipients User Manual

Version 1.0.4

1. Purpose of the Application

Newsletter Recipients is a desktop application for maintaining a database of people who receive a newsletter by email, postal mail, or both.

The application allows you to:

- Add new recipient records
- Search existing records by last name
- Load and edit existing records
- Delete records
- Export records to Excel
- Export records to CSV
- Import records from CSV
- Export mailing labels in two common Avery-compatible layouts
- Create CSV import exception reports
- Use CSV export as a database backup method

2. Main Window Overview

The main window is divided into four general areas:

1. **Data Entry Form** on the left
2. **Search by Last Name** display in the center
3. **Database Status** below the search area
4. **Export, Import, Load, and Delete Controls** on the right and lower center

3. Data Entry Fields

Each recipient record may include the following fields.

Title

Use this field for honorifics or titles, for example:

- Mr.
- Mrs.
- Ms.
- Miss
- Dr.
- Fr.
- Sr.
- Deacon
- The Rev.
- The Family of

By default, the app formats the Title field by capitalizing the entry and adding a period where appropriate. For example:

- mr becomes Mr .
- DR becomes Dr .
- Fr becomes Fr .
- miss remains Miss

If you do not want the app to change capitalization or punctuation in the Title field, select the **Exact** checkbox to the right of the Title field before saving or updating the record.

See “5. Exact Checkboxes” below.

First Name

Enter the recipient’s first name or names. By default, the app capitalizes the first name. It also allows the stand-alone word **and** to remain lowercase. For example:

- john becomes John
- john and mary becomes John and Mary
- ALEJANDRO AND ELENA becomes Alejandro and Elena

If you want the first name saved exactly as typed due to unusual capitalization or punctuation, select the **Exact** checkbox to the right of the First Name field. (This is not necessary unless some unusual capitalization or punctuation is present in the name.)

See “5. Exact Checkboxes” below.

Last Name

Enter the recipient’s last name.

By default, the app capitalizes the last name. If you want the last name saved exactly as typed, select the **Exact** checkbox to the right of the Last Name field.

See “5. Exact Checkboxes” below.

Area Code

Enter a 3-digit area code. Parentheses are not required.

Examples:

- 620
- (620)

The app stores only the digits and displays/export formats the area code as needed.

Phone Number

Enter the 7-digit phone number. A dash is not required but is allowed.

Examples:

- 5551212
- 555-1212

The app stores only the digits and displays/export formats the number as needed.

Email Address

Enter the recipient’s email address. Email addresses are saved in lowercase as email addresses are not case-sensitive.

If the **Email list** checkbox is selected, an email address is required.

Address 1

Enter the first mailing address line.

Examples:

- 123 Main St
- PO Box 45
- General Delivery
- Sacred Heart Church

By default, the app applies address capitalization and formatting. It also allows stand-alone **and** to remain lowercase.

If you want Address 1 saved exactly as typed, select the **Exact** checkbox to the right of the Address 1 field. (This is not necessary unless some unusual capitalization or punctuation is present in the Address 1 line.)

See “5. Exact Checkboxes” below.

Address 2

Enter an **optional** second mailing address line (if needed). Leave this field blank if it is not required.

Examples:

- Apt 2
- Suite 400
- c/o Parish Office
- Building A

By default, the app applies address capitalization and formatting. It also allows stand-alone **and** to remain lowercase.

If you want Address 2 saved exactly as typed, select the **Exact** checkbox to the right of the Address 2 field. (This is not necessary unless some unusual capitalization or punctuation is present in the Address 2 line.)

See “5. Exact Checkboxes” below.

City

Enter the city. By default, the app capitalizes the city name and allows stand-alone **and** to remain lowercase.

If you want the city saved exactly as typed, select the **Exact** checkbox to the right of the City field. (This is not necessary unless some unusual capitalization or punctuation is present in the City name.)

See “5. Exact Checkboxes” below.

State

Enter the state abbreviation. The app automatically forces this field to uppercase.

Example:

- ks becomes KS

ZIP Code

Enter a 5-digit ZIP code. If the **Mail list** checkbox is selected, ZIP code is required.

4. List Selection Checkboxes

Each record must be assigned to at least one list.

Email list

Select this if the recipient should receive the newsletter by email. If selected, an email address is required.

Mail list

Select this if the recipient should receive the newsletter by postal mail. If selected, the following fields are required:

- Address 1 (but not Address 2)
- City
- State
- ZIP Code

A record may be assigned to both the Email list and Mail list.

5. Exact Checkboxes

The app includes **Exact** checkboxes beside these fields:

- Title
- First Name
- Last Name
- Address 1
- Address 2
- City

When an **Exact** checkbox is selected, the corresponding field is saved exactly as typed, except that leading and trailing spaces are removed.

Use **Exact** when the app's automatic capitalization or punctuation do not produce the desired result.

Examples where Exact may be useful:

- Names with unusual capitalization
- Business names
- Religious titles
- Names in languages other than English
- Compound names
- Innovative non-traditional names
- Addresses with nonstandard capitalization or punctuation
- City names requiring unusual capitalization or punctuation

The Exact checkboxes apply only when manually saving or updating a record. They do not affect CSV import.

Best practice for using the Exact checkboxes is to save the record without selecting any Exact checkboxes, then view the record (by repopulating it in the entry fields using the ID and Load Record, or by double-clicking it in the Search Results list; or in an exported Excel file or a Label export file).

If the app is altering the Title field or any part of the name or address in a way that is not correct or wanted, load the record back into the form (if you haven't already) by double-clicking it in the Search Results list or by entering the record ID in the ID to Edit or Delete field and clicking Load Record. Then revise whichever field(s) that need(s) to be changed and select the Exact box(es) next to that/those field(s). Update the record.

6. Saving a New Recipient

To save a new recipient:

1. Enter the recipient's information.
2. Select Email list, Mail list, or both.
3. Select any Exact checkboxes needed.
4. Click **Save Recipient**.

If the app detects a possible duplicate, it will display a warning and ask whether you still want to save the new record.

Possible duplicates may be detected by:

- Email address
- Phone number
- Same last name and Address 1

If you choose not to proceed, the new record will not be saved.

7. Resetting the Form

Click **Reset Form** to clear the entry form.

This also clears:

- Email list checkbox
- Mail list checkbox
- Exact checkboxes
- Loaded record status
- ID field

After reset, the Save button returns to normal new-record behavior.

8. Searching Records

Use the **Search by Last Name** area to find existing records.

To search:

1. Enter a full or partial last name.
2. Click **Search**.

The search results table displays:

- ID
- First Name
- Last Name
- Area Code
- Phone
- Email

To show every record in the database, click **Show All Records**.

Use the mouse's scroll wheel to scroll up and down in the Search Results.

9. Loading a Record for Editing

There are two ways to load a record.

Option 1: Load by ID

1. Enter the record ID in the **ID to Edit or Delete** field.
2. Click **Load Record**.

Option 2: Load from Search Results

1. Search for a record or click **Show All Records**.
2. Double-click the desired record in the search results table.

When a record is loaded:

- Its information appears in the form.
 - Its ID appears in the ID field.
 - The Save button changes to **Update Record**.
 - The Delete Record button becomes available.
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10. Updating a Record

To update an existing record:

1. Load the record by ID or by double-clicking a search result.
2. Make the desired changes.
3. Select any Exact checkboxes needed.
4. Click **Update Record**.

After the update, the form clears and the database status is refreshed.

11. Deleting a Record

To delete a record:

1. Load the record by ID or by double-clicking a search result.
2. Click **Delete Record**.
3. Confirm the deletion.

Deletion cannot be undone. If a record is deleted accidentally, it must be reentered manually or via update from an imported CSV file.

12. Combine Duplicates

The **Combine Duplicates** function allows you to merge two existing database records into one new combined record. This is useful when the same recipient has accidentally been entered more than once, or when two records contain different pieces of correct information for the same person.

Selecting Records to Combine

To use Combine Duplicates:

1. Search for the duplicate records using **Search by Last Name**, or click **Show All Records**.
2. Click the first record in the Search Results table.
3. Select the second record:
 - o On macOS, use **Cmd+click**.
 - o On Windows, use **Ctrl+click**.
4. When exactly two records are selected, the **Combine Duplicates** button becomes available. *(Only two records can be combined. If a third record is also involved, combine the first two records, then combine the third record with the new record that resulted from the first operation.)*
5. Click **Combine Duplicates**.

The Combine Duplicates button remains disabled unless exactly two records are selected.

Combine Duplicate Records Window

After clicking **Combine Duplicates**, the app opens a review window showing both selected records.

The window includes:

- The field name
- The value from Record 1
- The value from Record 2
- A **Combined Value** entry field
- Buttons to copy values from either record

Fields that differ between the two records are highlighted.

For each field, you may:

- Click **R1** to use the value from Record 1.
- Click **R2** to use the value from Record 2.
- Type your own corrected value directly into the **Combined Value** field.

The values in the **Combined Value** column are saved exactly as shown. Normal capitalization, punctuation, and address-formatting rules are not applied in this window.

For **Email List** and **Mail List**, use:

- 1 for selected/on
- 0 for unselected/off

Saving the Combined Record

When you click **Save Combined Record and Delete Originals**, the app displays a warning before making any changes.

If you confirm, the app will:

1. Save one new combined record with a new unique ID.
2. Delete both original records.
3. Refresh the database status and Search Results.

This action cannot be undone. If you are not sure the combined information is correct, click **Cancel** instead.

Required Information

The combined record must include:

- First Name
- Last Name
- At least one list selection: Email List, Mail List, or both

If **Email List** is selected, an email address is required.

If **Mail List** is selected, the following fields are required:

- Address 1
- City
- State
- ZIP Code

Recommended Practice

Before combining duplicate records, it is recommended that you create a CSV backup using **Export All (CSV)**.

After combining records, review the new combined record by searching for it in the Search Results table or exporting the database to Excel.

13. Database Status Display

Below the search results area, the app displays:

- Database path
- Total records
- Mail list records
- Email list records
- Last update

The database path shows where the active database file is stored.

- On macOS, the database is stored in the user's Application Support folder.
- On Windows, the database is stored in the current user's AppData\Roaming\NewsletterRecipients folder, typically C:\Users\<username>\AppData\Roaming\NewsletterRecipients.

The Last Update display shows the time, day, and date of the last Save, Update, Delete, or CSV Import:

14:34:21 Wed May 27 2026

14. Excel Export Options

The app can export database records to Excel format.

Export All (Excel)

Exports all records in the database to an Excel file.

The export includes:

- ID
- Title
- First Name
- Last Name
- Area Code
- Phone
- Email
- Address 1
- Address 2

- City
- State
- ZIP Code
- Email list
- Mail list

Export Email List (Excel)

Exports only records assigned to the Email list.

The export includes recipient name, email, area code, and phone information.

Export Mail List (Excel)

Exports only records assigned to the Mail list.

The export includes:

- ID
- Title
- First Name
- Last Name
- Area Code
- Phone
- Email
- Address 1
- Address 2
- City
- State
- ZIP Code
- Email list
- Mail list

15. Mailing Label Export Options

The app can export mailing labels to Word .docx format. Only records assigned to the Mail list are included.

14 Labels 1.75" x 4"

Exports a Word document formatted for 14 labels per page. The default filename is:

Newsletter 14 per page yyyy-mm-dd hhmm.docx

30 Labels 2.625" x 1"

Exports a Word document formatted for 30 labels per page. The default filename is:

Newsletter 30 per page yyyy-mm-dd hhmm.docx

Label Address Format

Labels print using the following format:

Recipient Name
Address 1
Address 2, if present
City, State ZIP

There are two spaces between the state abbreviation and ZIP code.

16. CSV Export

Click **Export All (CSV)** to export the full database to a CSV file.

The CSV export includes a source_db column identifying the database source, followed by the recipient fields.

CSV export is useful for:

- Moving records between computers
 - Sharing database records with another user
 - Backing up the database
 - Creating a restorable record list
 - Reviewing or editing records in spreadsheet software
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17. Using CSV Export as a Database Backup

CSV export is the recommended simple backup method. To create a backup:

1. Click **Export All (CSV)**.
2. Choose a safe location for the backup file.
3. Save the file with a date in the filename.

Recommended filename example:

newsletter_backup_2026-05-29.csv

Store backup CSV files somewhere safe, such as:

- External drive
- Cloud storage
- Backup folder
- Another computer

Recommended Backup Schedule

Create a CSV backup:

- Before importing a CSV file
- Before making large edits
- After completing major updates
- Before replacing or updating the app
- Periodically during normal use

Restoring from a CSV Backup

To restore records from a CSV backup:

1. Open the app.
2. Click **Import CSV**.
3. Select the backup CSV file.
4. Review any possible duplicates.
5. Choose whether to replace, partially update, skip, or cancel.

A CSV backup does not directly replace the database file. Instead, it imports records back into the active database.

18. CSV Import

Click **Import CSV** to import records from a CSV file.

CSV import is designed for records exported from another copy of Newsletter Recipients or from a previous backup.

CSV Import Policy

CSV data is treated as already-finalized data. During CSV import, the app does not apply the normal manual-entry formatting rules to imported fields. It assumes that the source user already made the intended formatting choices, either by allowing default normalization or by using Exact

checkboxes before exporting. Therefore, imported CSV fields are saved as they appear in the CSV file, except for leading and trailing spaces.

This applies to fields such as:

- Title
- First Name
- Last Name
- Area Code
- Phone
- Email
- Address 1
- Address 2
- City
- State
- ZIP Code

Required List Selection

A CSV record must be assigned to at least one list:

- Email list
- Mail list

If neither list is selected, the record will be rejected during import.

19. Duplicate Review During CSV Import

When importing a CSV file, the app checks for possible duplicates.

Possible duplicates may be detected by:

- Email address
- Phone number
- Same last name and Address 1 or Address 2 (or vice versa)

When a possible duplicate is found, the app opens the **Review Possible CSV Duplicate** window. This window compares:

- Existing database record
- CSV record

Field names are highlighted for fields that differ between the existing database and the CSV import file. You then choose one of the following options:

Replace Entire Existing Record

This replaces the existing database record with the CSV record.

The CSV record is saved as-is, without additional normalization.

Update Selected Fields Only

This lets you select individual CSV fields to apply to the existing database record. Only the selected CSV fields are added to the existing record. The selected CSV values are saved as-is, without additional normalization.

Skip CSV Duplicate

This skips the CSV record and leaves the existing database record unchanged.

Cancel Import

This cancels the import process.

20. CSV Import Exceptions Report

After a CSV import, the app creates a CSV update exceptions report.

The default filename is:

CSV Update Exceptions yyyy-mm-dd hhmm.txt

The report includes:

- Source CSV file
- Report creation date/time
- CSV records not added to the database
- CSV records partially added to the database
- Details of accepted and rejected fields for partial updates

If there are no exceptions, the report is still created and shows “None” under the relevant sections.

This report is useful for reviewing what happened during an import, especially when duplicate records were skipped or partially updated.

21. Recommended CSV Import Procedure

Before importing a CSV file:

1. Export a CSV backup of the current database.
2. Save the backup in a safe location.
3. Click **Import CSV**.
4. Select the CSV file to import.
5. Carefully review duplicate warnings.
6. Save the exceptions report.
7. Review the search results or Excel export to confirm the import.

This procedure helps prevent accidental data loss.

22. Recommended Workflow for Multiple Database Users

If more than one person maintains a copy of the database:

1. Each user should enter and format their own records carefully.
2. Each user should use the Exact checkboxes only when needed.
3. Each user should export CSV when sharing updates.
4. The receiving user should import the CSV.
5. During duplicate review, the receiving user should select the CSV fields they want to accept.
6. After import, the receiving user should review the exceptions report.

Because CSV import preserves imported values as-is, formatting choices made by the source user are retained.

23. Important Cautions

- Deleting a record cannot be undone.
- Always create a CSV backup before a large import.
- Ideally, save your exported CSV backup file to a different drive than the one where your database is located, like a removable drive.
- So as to avoid data errors in backups and when updating between distributed databases and several users, NEVER manually alter the contents of the CSV export file.
- CSV import may change existing records if you choose Replace or Update Selected Fields.
- Excel exports are useful for review, but CSV exports are better for backup and re-import.
- Label exports include only records on the Mail list.

- Email list exports include only records on the Email list.
- The app database is separate from the app itself, so replacing or updating the app should not overwrite the database.

24. Changes in version 1.0.4

The following changes were made in version 1.0.4:

A new Notes field is now:

- Added to the SQLite database schema.
- Automatically added to an existing database the next time the application launches. No manual database conversion is needed.
- Displayed beneath the Email List and Mail List checkboxes and above the Save and Reset buttons.
- Entered in a wrapped, multiline text box with a vertical scrollbar.
- Saved with new recipients.
- Loaded for display and editing.
- Updated when an existing record is changed.
- Cleared when the form is reset or after a record is saved.
- Preserved during CSV export and import.
- Included in Excel exports.
- Included in CSV duplicate comparisons, selective CSV updates, exception reports, and the Combine Duplicate Records window.
- Existing CSV backup files that do not contain a notes column will still import normally; imported notes default to blank.

Label export correction:

- Both Avery label exports now use a shared page-building function:
- The 14-label export creates additional 7-row × 2-column sheets as needed.
- The 30-label export creates additional 10-row × 3-column sheets as needed.
- A page break is inserted only when another page is required.
- The existing label dimensions, margins, ordering, and address formatting remain unchanged.